

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a newspaper article about cyber-spying:

Cyber-spying on kids

Last year, the Hong Kong Research Association interviewed around 1,000 people (500 parents and 500 children aged 10 to 19) on their internet use and social media habits.

The study found that over 90% of young people used social media compared to 80% of parents. However, when it came to Facebook, 75% of young people used Facebook while only 56% of parents used it.

The study also revealed that 13% of parents admitted using fake identities to check up on their children through Facebook. A further 6% used their children's username and password to access their social media accounts.

When interviewed, parents explained that they wanted to monitor their children's online activities, but had to create fake identities because children tended to set a level of privacy to exclude their parents. Children, however, did not like parents checking up on them. One reason given for not wanting to have parents as Facebook "friends" was because their parent might embarrass them by posting awkward comments or baby photos online.

Not all children felt this way, though. One S6 student said that she had no problems with her parents as Facebook "friends" because they already knew everything about her.

As members of your school's Computer Club, your group is to give a presentation to club members on the topic "Communicating with Parents through Social Media". You may want to talk about:

- whether parents should access their children's social media accounts
- why parents want to monitor their children's online activities
- why some children may not want their parents to be their Facebook "friends"
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do your parents use Facebook?
2. Do you communicate with your parents through social media?
3. Would you allow your parents to be your Facebook "friends"?
4. Should parents allow their young children to have Facebook accounts?
5. How would you feel if your parents did not allow you to have a Facebook account?
6. Would you give your social media username and password to your parents?
7. How would you feel if your parents created fake accounts to monitor your online activities?
8. Do parents have the right to spy on their children's online activities?